EAT



My Neighbor TOTORO

Film night, 1988

WITH LOVE, FROM THE KITCHEN

Dad, can we take the corn to Mother? It will make her feel better.

Satsuki

RECIPE BOX NO. 88

Kusakabe Country House

Soot Sprites Welcome

Corn for Mum, cucumbers from the stream.

SHOWTIME

Serve the cucumbers when Granny pulls them out of the cold stream.

88

Remember

1. The Catbus at the rainy bus stop
2. Soot sprites in the old house
3. Acorns planted in the garden
4. The big camphor tree
5. Kanta's granny and her fresh corn



RECIPE NO. 88

To Start

Granny's stream-cooled cucumbers

Granny's garden and the cold stream.

Grilled corn with soy butter

The corn Mei carries all the way to Mum.

Mains

Satsuki's bento boxes

The lunch Satsuki packs for everyone.

From the Kusakabe Country House.

RECIPE 1988

Something Sweet

Bus stop umbrella dorayaki

Lending Totoro an umbrella in the rain.

To Drink

Catbus iced barley tea with honey

The Catbus with its glowing eyes.

Serves everyone on the couch. Every drink alcohol free. Photos: TMDB.

PREP SHEET

My Neighbor Totoro

SERVES 4 / EXACT QUANTITIES

Shopping list

MEAT

- [ ] 500g chicken thighs

PRODUCE

- [ ] 6 small cucumbers
- [ ] 4 corn cobs
- [ ] 1 lemon

DAIRY

- [ ] 40g butter
- [ ] 7 eggs

FROZEN

- [ ] 100g frozen peas
- [ ] ice

PANTRY

- [ ] 3 tbsp white miso
- [ ] 5 tbsp honey
- [ ] 5 tbsp soy sauce
- [ ] 1 tsp caster sugar
- [ ] 400g sushi rice
- [ ] 2 tbsp caster sugar
- [ ] 1 jar pickled ginger
- [ ] 100g caster sugar
- [ ] 150g plain flour
- [ ] 1 tsp baking powder
- [ ] 300g red bean paste
- [ ] 4 tbsp roasted barley tea

How to make it

1 **Granny's stream-cooled cucumbers** SNACK

Soak 6 small cucumbers in a bowl of iced water for 30 minutes, the way Granny cools them in the stream. Cut into spears. Mix 3 tbsp white miso with 1 tbsp honey and 1 tbsp water and serve in a little dish for dipping.

2 **Grilled corn with soy butter** SNACK

Grill 4 corn cobs over high heat for 10 minutes, turning, until charred in spots. Melt 40g butter with 2 tbsp soy sauce and 1 tsp sugar and brush all over the corn while it's hot.

3 **Satsuki's bento boxes** MAIN

Cook 400g sushi rice. Fry 500g chicken thighs, then glaze with 3 tbsp soy and 2 tbsp sugar until sticky. Whisk 4 eggs with a pinch of sugar and roll into a thin omelette in a pan. Pack each box with rice topped with peas, sliced chicken, omelette and pickled ginger.

4 **Bus stop umbrella dorayaki** SWEET

Whisk 3 eggs with 100g sugar and 2 tbsp honey, then 150g flour, 1 tsp baking powder and 60ml water. Cook 16 small pancakes in a lightly oiled pan for 1 minute a side. Sandwich in pairs with 300g red bean paste.

5 **Catbus iced barley tea with honey** DRINK

Bring 1.2L water to the boil, add 4 tbsp roasted barley tea (or 3 tea bags) and simmer 5 minutes. Turn off the heat, stir in 2 tbsp honey and steep 10 minutes more. Strain and chill for at least 2 hours. Fill 4 tall glasses with ice, add 2 thin lemon slices to each and pour in the tea.

Showtime cue Serve the cucumbers when Granny pulls them out of the cold stream.